MICROSOFT SPECIFICATION

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DESCRIPTION	Microsoft Luxe Design System – Gold Master Standard (GMS)

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APPROVAL SIGNATURES			
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REVISION HISTORY

Revision	Release Date	Revision Description
A	5/31/2024	Initial Release
B	11/19/2024	Added Spring 25 colors (GMS-00209 - 00214), updated the attached .ase and .cxf files
C	09/23/2025	Added Spring 26 colors (GMS-00215 - 00218), updated the attached .ase and .cxf files

Color, GMS Program and Materials

Color unites us

The Microsoft color palette is one of the most unifying elements of our brand identity. It connects our products, devices, and services across all digital and print marketing communications.

Our colors are among our most recognizable brand elements. So much more than decoration, our color palette distinguishes our family of products. It enlivens our stories without dominating them. It reveals our personality. And, as a core branding element, it makes all our materials recognizably Microsoft.

The enclosed custom spot colors are used throughout our packaging design system to drive customer recognition and value in the Microsoft brand. As a premium brand, details matter, not only in the quality of our products but through the consistency in which all of our materials are reproduced across all locations and partners around the world.

Gold Master Standard

The Gold Master Standard (GMS) Program is Microsoft's mechanism for defining accurate and consistent reproduction of our spot colors. This GMS Folio includes Color Cards that define the measurement conditions, manufacturing tolerances and specifications for each custom spot color.

Each printer is responsible to match the color target definition of each color within the specified measurement condition and meet the tolerances defined in this specification.

When proofing these colors each printer must certify each proofing device to accurately produce these colors. The Color Reproduction Certification Program (S017511) defines these certification requirements, and submission procedure.

Materials

The specified ink target values remain the same regardless of the paper being used. Depending on the paper and coatings, inks may require unique formulations to ensure the tolerances are met *after* all processing is complete.

All tolerances are calculated from the difference between the supplied values and measured value of finished print dry inks and coatings using the specified measurement conditions.

The paper material is to be measured upon incoming inspection to ensure it meets the specifications prior to print manufacturing.

Proper viewing conditions are under controlled D50 lighting to ensure a visual match for both hue and brightness, defined in ISO-3664:2009.

All inks must be vegetable-based inks and compliant with Laws and regulations for Mineral Oil Free inks (https://www.legifrance.gouv.fr/jorf/id/JORFTEXT000045733481).

Frequently Asked Questions (FAQ)

Proofing

Do we need to ensure our CRCP proofs match these spot colors and tolerances? Yes, accuracy of these colors on proofs is important. We must be able to accurately assess the relationship between screens/tints, other colors, elements, and renders. See these specs for more information:

- **S017511** Color Reproduction Certification and Color Management Program (CRCP)
- **S017529** Color Management Process Control Settings & Procedures

Overprinting GMS inks

When overprinting another color, does the GMS color need to meet specified tolerance? No, when overprinting another ink, it's understood that the color won't match the specified target. The GMS ink must meet the specification, measured on a coated area with no overprinting. This ensures the GMS ink is accurate and our designers can anticipate how other colors will overlap for predictable outcomes.

GMS inks printed as CMYK

Can we print these GMS spot colors as process CMYK? If the art you receive is spot ink, we require you to print it as spot ink and meet the tolerances defined in this specification. See the section about Digital presses for more information.

Digital press usage

Can I print these spot colors on a digital press? Only if a digital press has met the yearly CRCP certification can Microsoft give permission to print a design that uses spot colors as process colors.

When printing these colors on a digital press, please reach out to **gmsadmin@microsoft.com** to discuss your tolerances and coordinate physical sample reviews and qualification.

Custom spot colors

Why don't you use Pantone or another color library? Even with thousands of colors in commercial color library systems, they do not provide the specific colors Microsoft needs.

Tight tolerances

Why does Microsoft require such tight tolerances? The GMS program lets us define specific colors without compromise, achieve greater consistency across materials and print processes. Having stricter tolerances leads to better customer experiences with the Microsoft brand and our products.

Physical target samples

Are physical samples available for these colors? Microsoft has stopped making or distributing printed physical samples of colors. These kinds of samples do not last overtime and often become faded, yellowed, or significantly shift in hue even when the samples are stored properly. This leads to difficulty detecting misalignment between Microsoft's expectations and the printer's understanding of our expectations, which can result in costly rejection of materials.

Microsoft strongly discourages printers from creating their own physical samples of these colors to be used for visual matching. Physical and visual matching processes have inherent flaws which make consistently matching our tolerances unrealistic.

The color specifications and tolerances are defined by specific measurement and observation conditions D50/2° M1 Condition (ISO 13655:2009). When followed, this method ensures target colors can be reproduced consistently and accurately regardless of the equipment, individual or location. It also enables print manufacturers to collect performance and accuracy data and share with Microsoft through the **S018355** *Print Quality Management (PQM) Program* (if applicable).

Support Files and Attachments

Attachments are embedded in this PDF file.

Please save them to your computer and load them into the Adobe applications or your Spectrophotometer.

For use in Adobe applications:

1) PRINT - MS Luxe Swatches_M1321086_Rev-C.ase

- **Spot Inks**
- **CMYK/Process colors**
- **2X - Spot Inks** (used when a double bump is needed for uniform coverage.
  The measured end result must still match the GMS specification.)

2) RGB COLORS - MS Luxe Swatches_M1321086_Rev-C.ase

For use with X-rite eXact Spectrophotometers:

Notes:

- *These .cxf files include spectral curves and SPOT ink target values and tolerances as defined in this document.*
- *There is a limit on how many colors can be included in each .cxf fie. therefore multiple .cxf files have been created and attached.*

3) MS Luxe GMS Colors_M1321086_Set 1.cxf

- *This set includes data for GMS -00200 - 00214*

4) MS Luxe GMS Colors_M1321086_Set 2.cxf

- *This set includes data for GMS -00215 - 00218*

Microsoft Luxe LITE Gray GMS – 00200

Reproduction Tolerance

These specified ink target values remain the same regardless of the paper, inks, coatings/surface treatments used, ensuring a consistent customer experience.

Printers must compensate for the impact of the dry-back characteristics of inks, coatings and paper on the finished color. Tolerances are calculated from the difference between the supplied values below and the measured value of what has been produced *after* all inks and coatings are dry and processing is complete.

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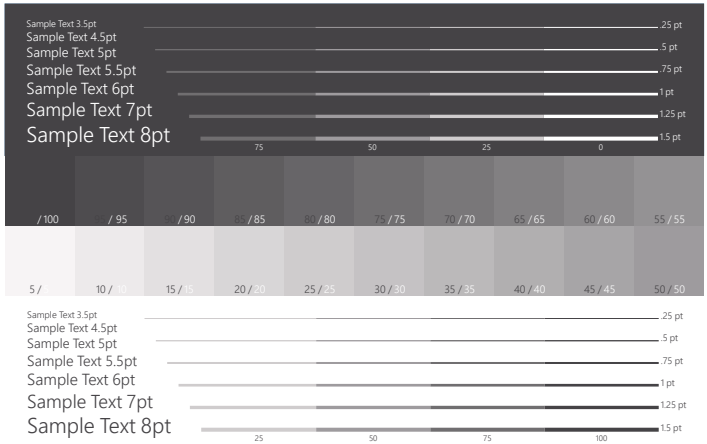
Proper viewing conditions are under controlled D50 lighting to ensure a visual match for both hue and brightness, defined in ISO-3664:2009.

LUXE LITE GRAY GMS-00200				
D50/2° M1 Condition (ISO 13655:2009)				
L* 88.5	a* 1	b* -1.5	C* 1.8	h° 303.7

Level 1 Tolerance	Level 2 Tolerance
ΔE00, D50/2°, M1	ΔL*a*b*, D50/2°, M1
KL* **1**	ΔL* ± **1**
KC* **1**	Δa* ± 1
KH* **1**	Δb* ± **1**
ΔE00 <**1.0**	

Microsoft Luxe DARK Gray GMS – 00201



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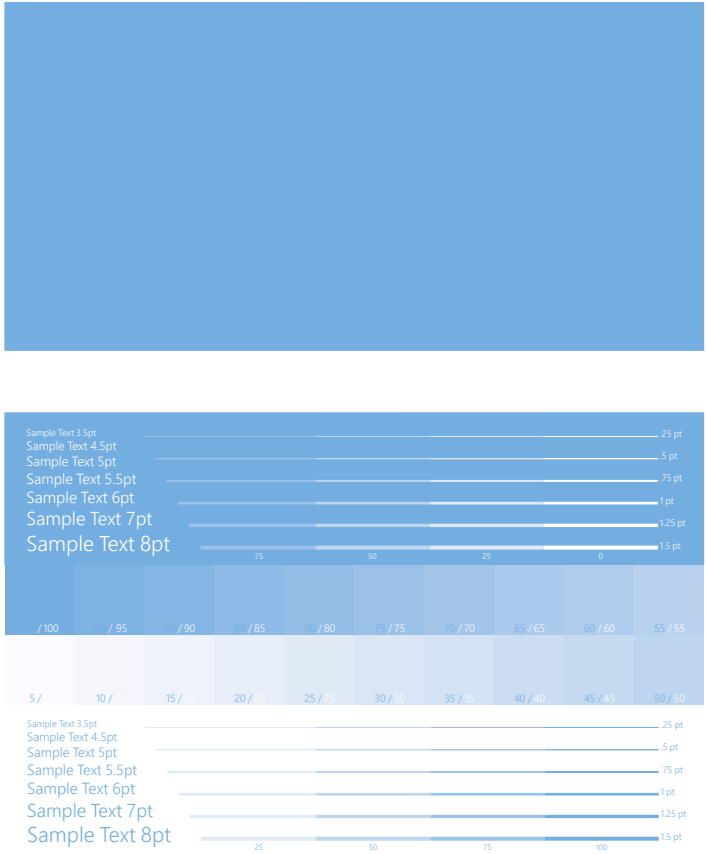
LUXE DARK GRAY GMS-00201				
D50/2° M1 Condition (ISO 13655:2009)				
L* 29	a* 1	b* -1.5	C* 1.8	h° 303.7

Level 1 Tolerance	Level 2 Tolerance
ΔE00, D50/2°, M1	ΔL*a*b*, D50/2°, M1
KL* **1**	ΔL* ± **1**
KC* **1**	Δa* ± 1
KH* **1**	Δb* ± **1**
ΔE00 <**1.0**	

Microsoft Luxe SAPPHIRE GMS – 00202



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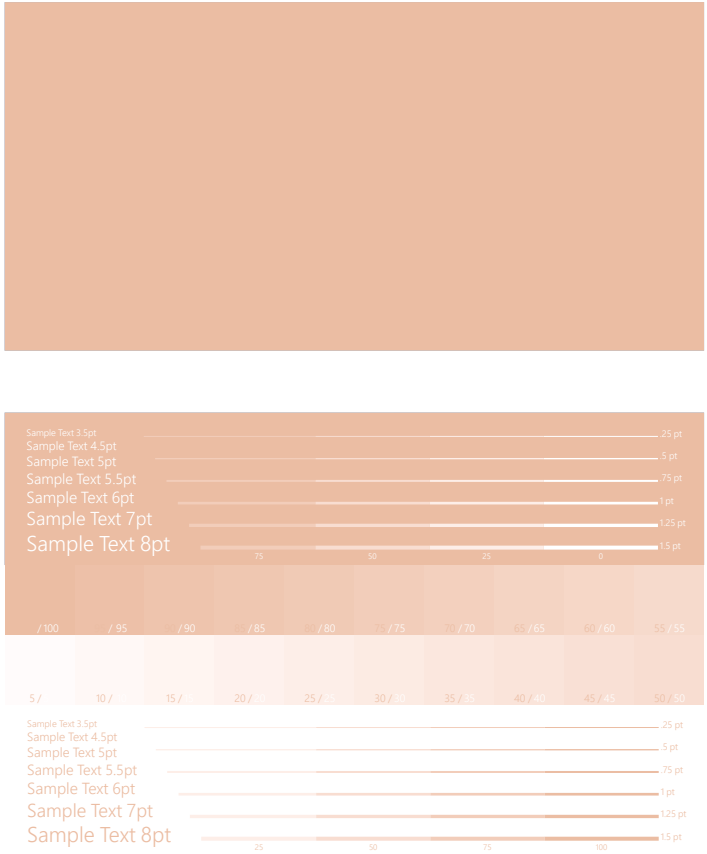
LUXE SAPPHIRE GMS-00202				
D50/2° M1 Condition (ISO 13655:2009)				
L* 68.8	a* -6.0	b* -31	C* 31.6	h° 259.0

Level 1 Tolerance	Level 2 Tolerance
ΔE00, D50/2°, M1	ΔL*a*b*, D50/2°, M1
KL* **1**	ΔL* ± **1**
KC* **1**	Δa* ± **1**
KH* **1**	Δb* ± **1**
ΔE00 <**1.0**	

Microsoft Luxe DUNE GMS – 00203



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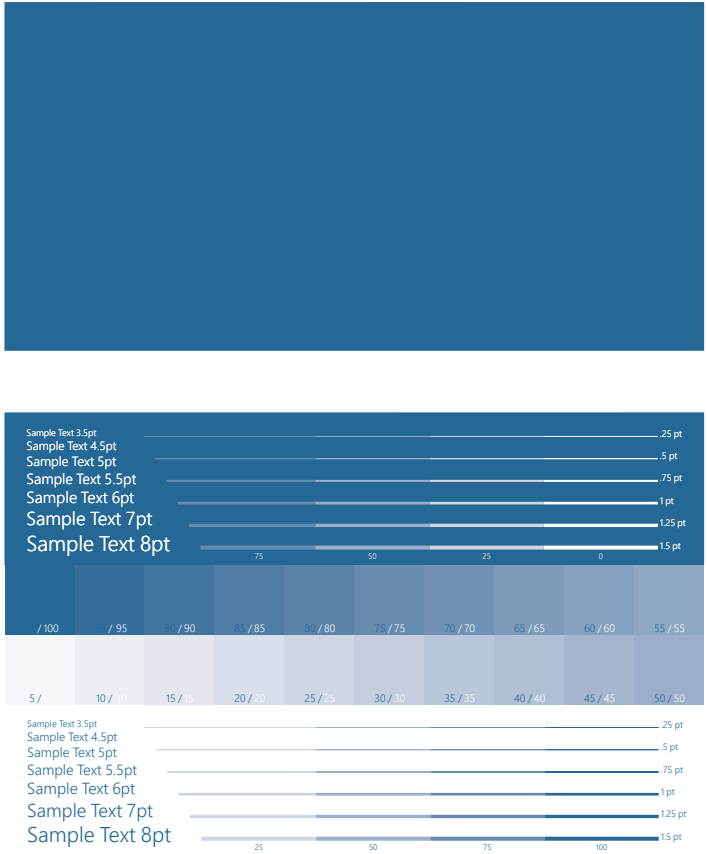
LUXE DUNE GMS-00203

D50/2° M1 Condition (ISO 13655:2009)				
L* 80	**a* 11.7**	**b*19.2**	**C* 22.5**	**h° 58.7**

Level 1 Tolerance	Level 2 Tolerance
ΔE00, D50/2°, M1	ΔL*a*b*, D50/2°, M1
KL* **1**	ΔL* ± **1**
KC* **1**	Δa* ± **1**
KH* **1**	Δb* ± **1**
ΔE00 <**1.0**	

Microsoft Luxe 2ry Sapphire GMS – 00204



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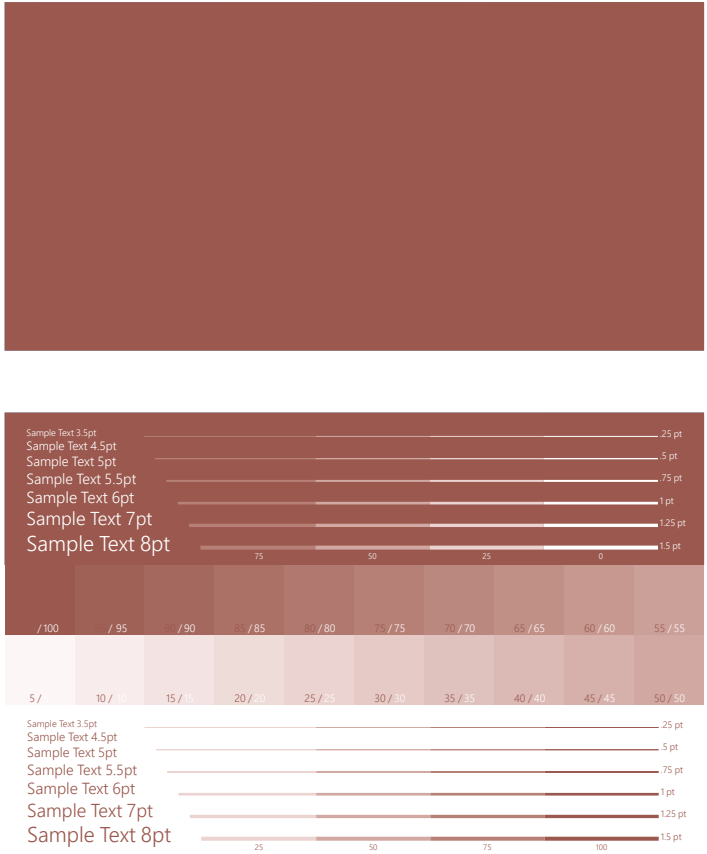
Proper viewing conditions are under controlled D50 lighting to ensure a visual match for both hue and brightness, defined in ISO-3664:2009.

LUXE 2RY SAPPHIRE GMS-00204				
D50/2° M1 Condition (ISO 13655:2009)				
L* 42	a* -5	b* -31	C* 31.4	h° 260.8

Level 1 Tolerance	Level 2 Tolerance
ΔE00, D50/2°, M1	ΔL*a*b*, D50/2°, M1
KL* **1**	ΔL* ± **1**
KC* **1**	Δa* ± **1**
KH* **1**	Δb* ± **1**
ΔE00 <**1.5**	

Microsoft Luxe 2ry DUNE GMS – 00205



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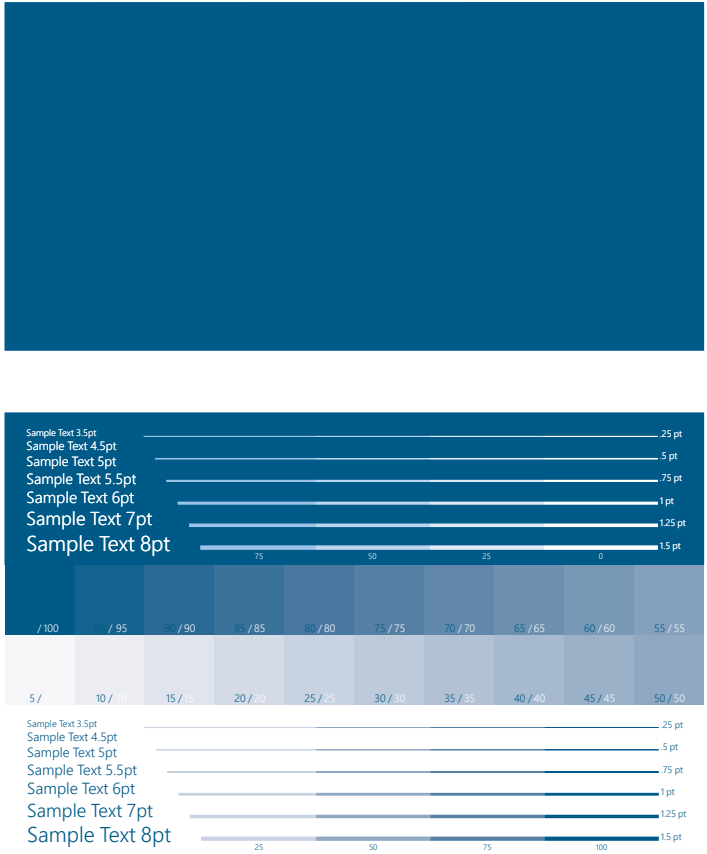
LUXE 2RY DUNE GMS-00205				
D50/2° M1 Condition (ISO 13655:2009)				
L* 45	a* 25	b* 18	C* 30.8	h° 35.8

Level 1 Tolerance	Level 2 Tolerance
ΔE00, D50/2°, M1	ΔL*a*b*, D50/2°, M1
KL* **1**	ΔL* ± **1**
KC* **1**	Δa* ± 1
KH* **1**	Δb* ± **1**
ΔE00 <**1.5**	

Microsoft Luxe Acc Sapphire GMS – 00206



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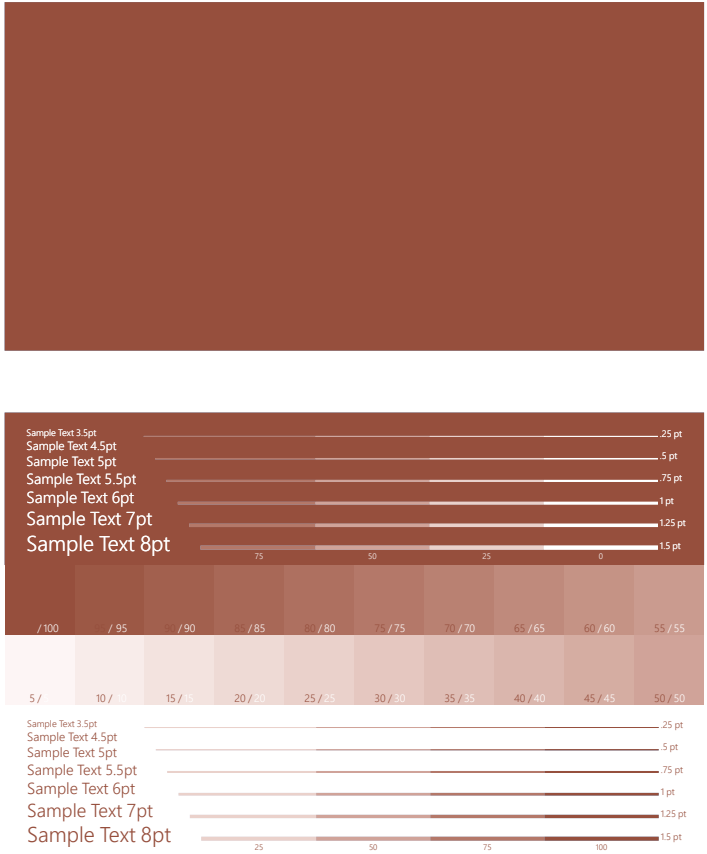
Proper viewing conditions are under controlled D50 lighting to ensure a visual match for both hue and brightness, defined in ISO-3664:2009.

LUXE ACC SAPPHIRE GMS-00206				
D50/2° M1 Condition (ISO 13655:2009)				
L* 36	a* -7	b* -32	C* 31.9	h° 260.4

Level 1 Tolerance	Level 2 Tolerance
ΔE00, D50/2°, M1	ΔL*a*b*, D50/2°, M1
KL* **1**	ΔL* ± **1**
KC* **1**	Δa* ± 1
KH* **1**	Δb* ± **1**
ΔE00 <**1.5**	

Microsoft Luxe Acc DUNE GMS – 00207



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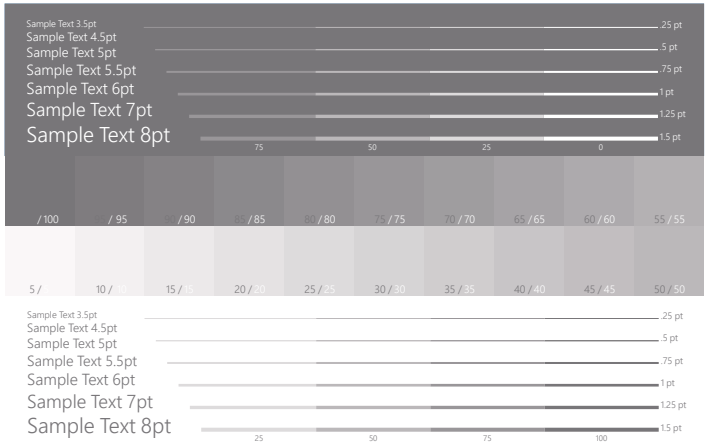
LUXE ACC DUNE GMS-00207				
D50/2° M1 Condition (ISO 13655:2009)				
L* 42	a* 27	b* 24	C* 36.1	h° 41.6

Level 1 Tolerance	Level 2 Tolerance
ΔE00, D50/2°, M1	ΔL*a*b*, D50/2°, M1
KL* **1**	ΔL* ± **1**
KC* **1**	Δa* ± 1
KH* **1**	Δb* ± **1**
ΔE00 <**1.5**	

Microsoft Luxe MEDIUM Gray GMS – 00208



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Proper viewing conditions are under controlled D50 lighting to ensure a visual match for both hue and brightness, defined in ISO-3664:2009.

LUXE MEDIUM GRAY GMS-00208				
D50/2° M1 Condition (ISO 13655:2009)				
L* 50	a* 1	b* -1.5	C* 1.8	h° 303.7

Level 1 Tolerance	Level 2 Tolerance
ΔE00, D50/2°, M1	ΔL*a*b*, D50/2°, M1
KL* **1**	ΔL* ± **1**
KC* **1**	Δa* ± 1
KH* **1**	Δb* ± **1**
ΔE00 <**1.5**	

Microsoft Luxe Violet BKG GMS – 00209

Reproduction Tolerance

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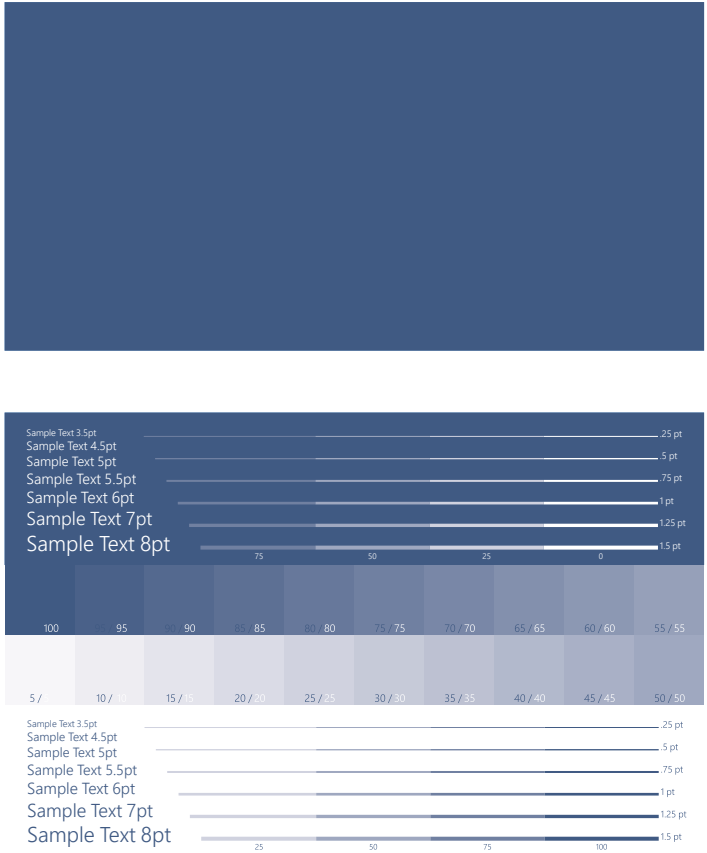
LUXE VIOLET BKG GMS-00209				
D50/2° M1 Condition (ISO 13655:2009)				
L* 67.7	**a* 1.9**	**b* -22.5**	**C* 22.6**	**h° 274.9**

Level 1 Tolerance	Level 2 Tolerance
ΔE00, D50/2°, M1	ΔL*a*b*, D50/2°, M1
KL* **1**	ΔL* ± **1**
KC* **1**	Δa* ± 1
KH* **1**	Δb* ± **1**
ΔE00 <**1.0**	

Microsoft Luxe VIOLET TXT GMS – 00210



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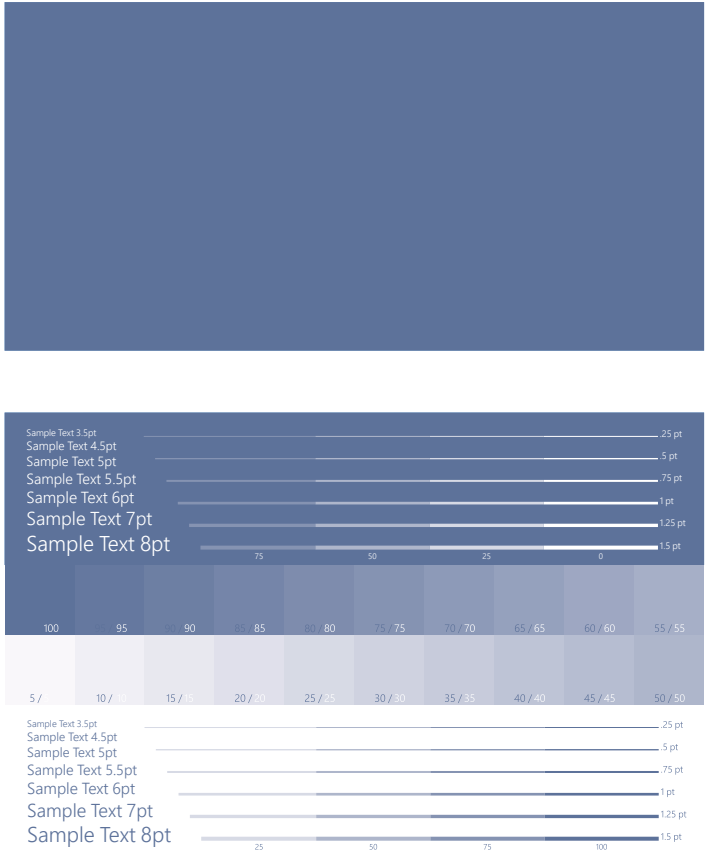
LUXE VIOLET TXT GMS-00210				
D50/2° M1 Condition (ISO 13655:2009)				
L* 38	**a* 2.4**	**b* -25.6**	**C* 25.8**	**h° 275.3**

Level 1 Tolerance	Level 2 Tolerance
ΔE00, D50/2°, M1	ΔL*a*b*, D50/2°, M1
KL* **1**	ΔL* ± **1**
KC* **1**	Δa* ± 1
KH* **1**	Δb* ± **1**
ΔE00 <**1.5**	

Microsoft Luxe VIOLET 2RY GMS – 00211



Reproduction Tolerance

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Printers must compensate for the impact of the dry-back characteristics of inks, coatings and paper on the finished color. Tolerances are calculated from the difference between the supplied values below and the measured value of what has been produced *after* all inks and coatings are dry and processing is complete.

Microsoft does not create or distribute physical targets of these colors. These types of samples change over time often fading, yellowing, or dramatically shifting in color hue even when the samples have been stored properly.

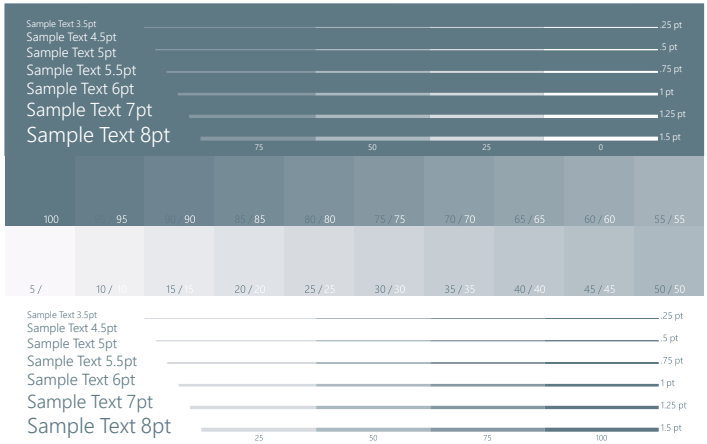
Microsoft strongly discourages printers from creating their own physical samples of these colors to be used for visual matching. Physical and visual matching processes have inherent flaws which make consistently matching our tolerances unrealistic. Inaccurate physical color targets lead to error-stacking and result in inaccuracies of the colors produced which will result in expensive reprints and continuity of supply risks. The values and tolerance below are the **Gold Master Standard (GMS)** targets for this color.

Proper viewing conditions are under controlled D50 lighting to ensure a visual match for both hue and brightness, defined in ISO-3664:2009.

LUXE VIOLET 2RY GMS-00211				
D50/2° M1 Condition (ISO 13655:2009)				
L* 47.8	**a* 2.3**	**b* -24**	**C* 24.1**	**h° 275.5**

Level 1 Tolerance	Level 2 Tolerance
ΔE00, D50/2°, M1	ΔL*a*b*, D50/2°, M1
KL* **1**	ΔL* ± **1**
KC* **1**	Δa* ± 1
KH* **1**	Δb* ± **1**
ΔE00 <**1.5**	

Microsoft Luxe OCEAN BKG GMS – 00212



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Proper viewing conditions are under controlled D50 lighting to ensure a visual match for both hue and brightness, defined in ISO-3664:2009.

LUXE OCEAN BKG GMS-00212				
D50/2° M1 Condition (ISO 13655:2009)				
L* 49.3	**a* -7.2**	**b* -10.3**	**C* 12.6**	**h° 235.3**

Level 1 Tolerance	Level 2 Tolerance
ΔE00, D50/2°, M1	ΔL*a*b*, D50/2°, M1
KL* **1**	ΔL* ± **1**
KC* **1**	Δa* ± 1
KH* **1**	Δb* ± **1**
ΔE00 <**1.0**	

Microsoft Luxe OCEAN TXT GMS – 00213

Reproduction Tolerance

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LUXE OCEAN TXT GMS-00213				
D50/2° M1 Condition (ISO 13655:2009)				
L* 81.3	**a* -8.5**	**b* -6.2**	**C* 10.5**	**h° 216.1**

Level 1 Tolerance	Level 2 Tolerance
ΔE00, D50/2°, M1	ΔL*a*b*, D50/2°, M1
KL* **1**	ΔL* ± **1**
KC* **1**	Δa* ± **1**
KH* **1**	Δb* ± **1**
ΔE00 <**1.5**	

Microsoft Luxe OCEAN 2RY GMS – 00214

Reproduction Tolerance

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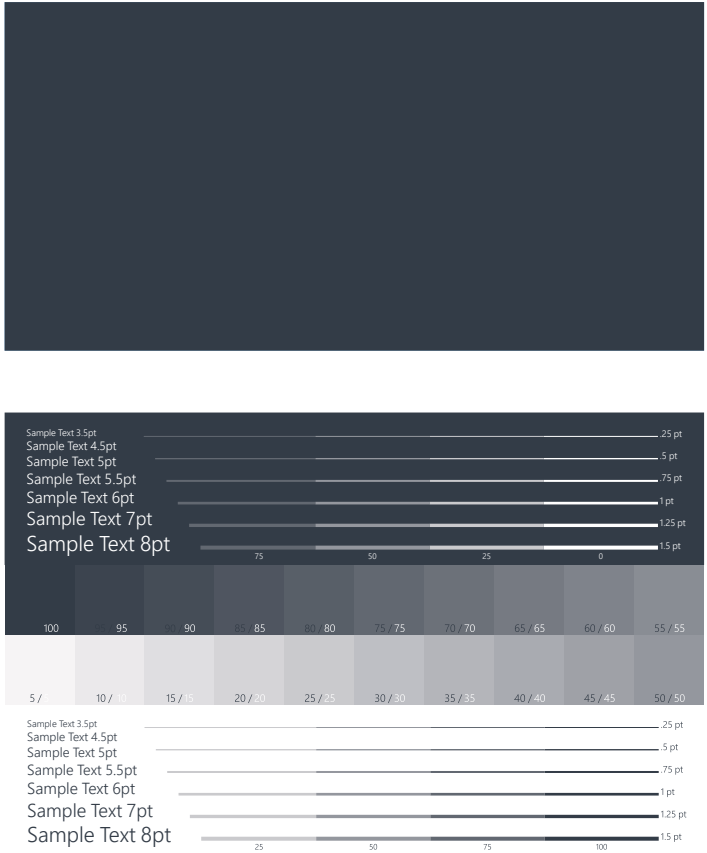
LUXE OCEAN 2RY GMS-00214				
D50/2° M1 Condition (ISO 13655:2009)				
L* 77.9	**a* -10.8**	**b* -6.2**	**C* 12.4**	**h° 209.8**

Level 1 Tolerance	Level 2 Tolerance
ΔE00, D50/2°, M1	ΔL*a*b*, D50/2°, M1
KL* **1**	ΔL* ± **1**
KC* **1**	Δa* ± 1
KH* **1**	Δb* ± **1**
ΔE00 <**1.5**	

Microsoft Luxe DARKSTEEL GMS – 00215



Reproduction Tolerance

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Proper viewing conditions are under controlled D50 lighting to ensure a visual match for both hue and brightness, defined in ISO-3664:2009.

LUXE DARKSTEEL GMS-00215				
D50/2° M1 Condition (ISO 13655:2009)				
L* 25	**a* 0**	**b* -7.5**	**C* 7.5**	**h° 270**

Level 1 Tolerance	Level 2 Tolerance
ΔE00, D50/2°, M1	ΔL*a*b*, D50/2°, M1
KL* **1**	ΔL* ± **1**
KC* **1**	Δa* ± 1
KH* **1**	Δb* ± **1**
ΔE00 <**1.0**	

Microsoft Luxe DARKSTEEL TXT GMS – 00216

Reproduction Tolerance

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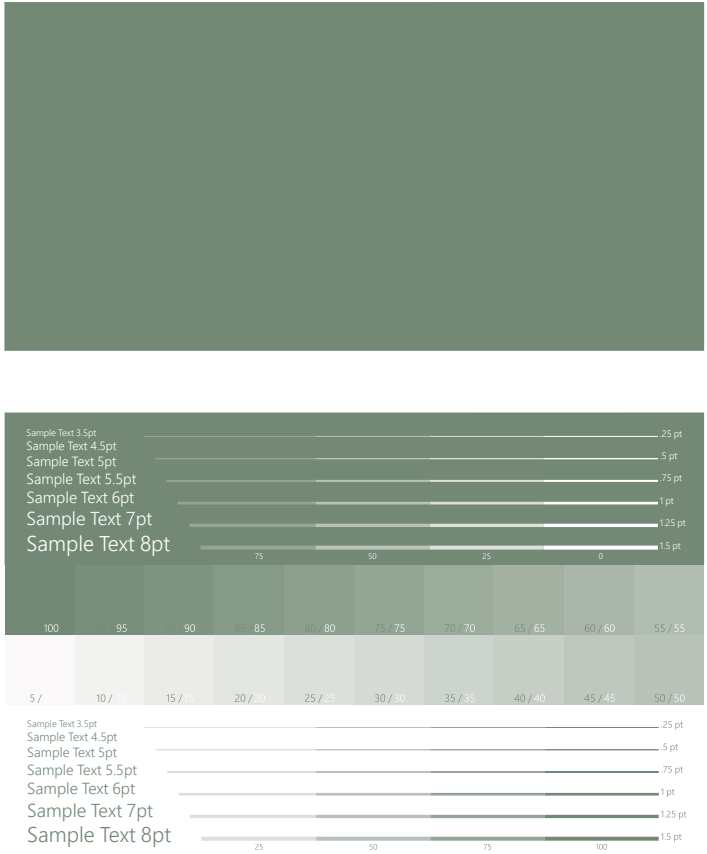
Proper viewing conditions are under controlled D50 lighting to ensure a visual match for both hue and brightness, defined in ISO-3664:2009.

LUXE DARKSTEEL TXT GMS-00216				
D50/2° M1 Condition (ISO 13655:2009)				
L* 69	**a* 0**	**b* -10**	**C* 10**	**h° 270**

Level 1 Tolerance	Level 2 Tolerance
ΔE00, D50/2°, M1	ΔL*a*b*, D50/2°, M1
KL* **1**	ΔL* ± **1**
KC* **1**	Δa* ± 1
KH* **1**	Δb* ± **1**
ΔE00 <**1.5**	

Microsoft Luxe EMERALD GMS – 00217



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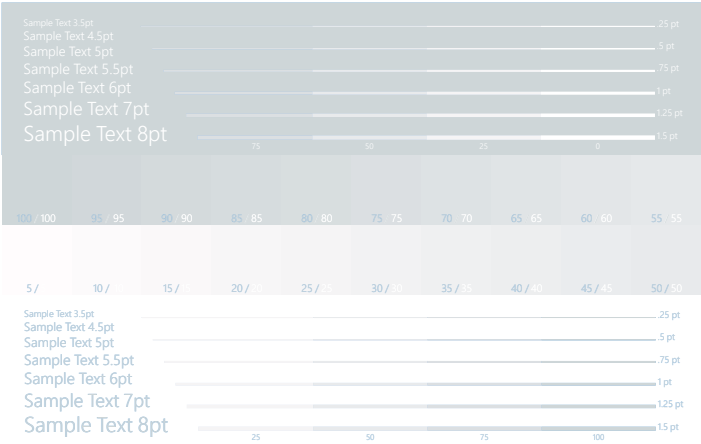
Proper viewing conditions are under controlled D50 lighting to ensure a visual match for both hue and brightness, defined in ISO-3664:2009.

LUXE EMERALD GMS-00217				
D50/2° M1 Condition (ISO 13655:2009)				
L* 55	a* -12	b* 7.5	C* 14	h° 148

Level 1 Tolerance	Level 2 Tolerance
ΔE00, D50/2°, M1	ΔL*a*b*, D50/2°, M1
KL* **1**	ΔL* ± **1**
KC* **1**	Δa* ± 1
KH* **1**	Δb* ± **1**
ΔE00 <**1.0**	

Microsoft Luxe EMERALD TXT GMS – 00218



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LUXE EMERALD TXT GMS-00218				
D50/2° M1 Condition (ISO 13655:2009)				
L* 85	**a* -3**	**b* -2**	**C* 3.6**	**h° 213.7**

Level 1 Tolerance	Level 2 Tolerance
ΔE00, D50/2°, M1	ΔL*a*b*, D50/2°, M1
KL* **1**	ΔL* ± **1**
KC* **1**	Δa* ± 1
KH* **1**	Δb* ± **1**
ΔE00 <**1.5**	

If you have any questions regarding this specification, referenced files or any GMS process information, please email:

gmsadmin@microsoft.com